



Türkiye's Low Happiness Ranking



World Happiness Report 2025

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

BY

MARCH 19 PLATFORM

JANUARY 16, 2026



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BLOCKING THE BALLOT THROUGH THE COURTS

*DIPLOMA ANNULMENT, PRISON, AND THE EROSION OF
DEMOCRACY IN TÜRKİYE*



From Marmara Prison, Ekrem İmamoğlu says the retroactive annulment of his decades-old university diploma under prosecutorial pressure and his continued imprisonment show how the judiciary is being used to bar the opposition's presidential candidate in Türkiye, turning any election without him into a referendum on repression rather than democratic choice.



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BACK TO PRISON 48 HOURS AFTER SURGERY

*DETAINED MAYOR MURAT ÇALIK SENT BACK TO PRISON
DESPITE HEALTH RISKS*



Murat Çalik, the jailed mayor of İstanbul's Beylikdüzü district, was sent back to prison immediately after a three-hour surgery near his carotid artery despite a documented cancer history, as opposition figures warn that continued detention poses serious risks to his health amid a broad investigation targeting CHP-run municipalities.



JANUARY 16, 2026

ATTEMPTED FEMICIDE IN THE COURTHOUSE

*WHETHER YOU ARE A JUDGE OR A CITIZEN, AS LONG AS
YOU ARE A WOMAN...*



A male public prosecutor shot Aslı Kahraman, a female judge, inside an İstanbul courthouse, an attempted femicide showing that violence against women in Türkiye persists even within the justice system itself.

Women's rights groups point to Türkiye's withdrawal from the Istanbul Convention as a key factor in the normalization and escalation of such violence.

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İMAMOĞLU AWARDED WHILE IN CUSTODY

*EKREM İMAMOĞLU RECEIVES THE PAWEŁ
ADAMOWICZ AWARD FOR LOCAL DEMOCRACY*



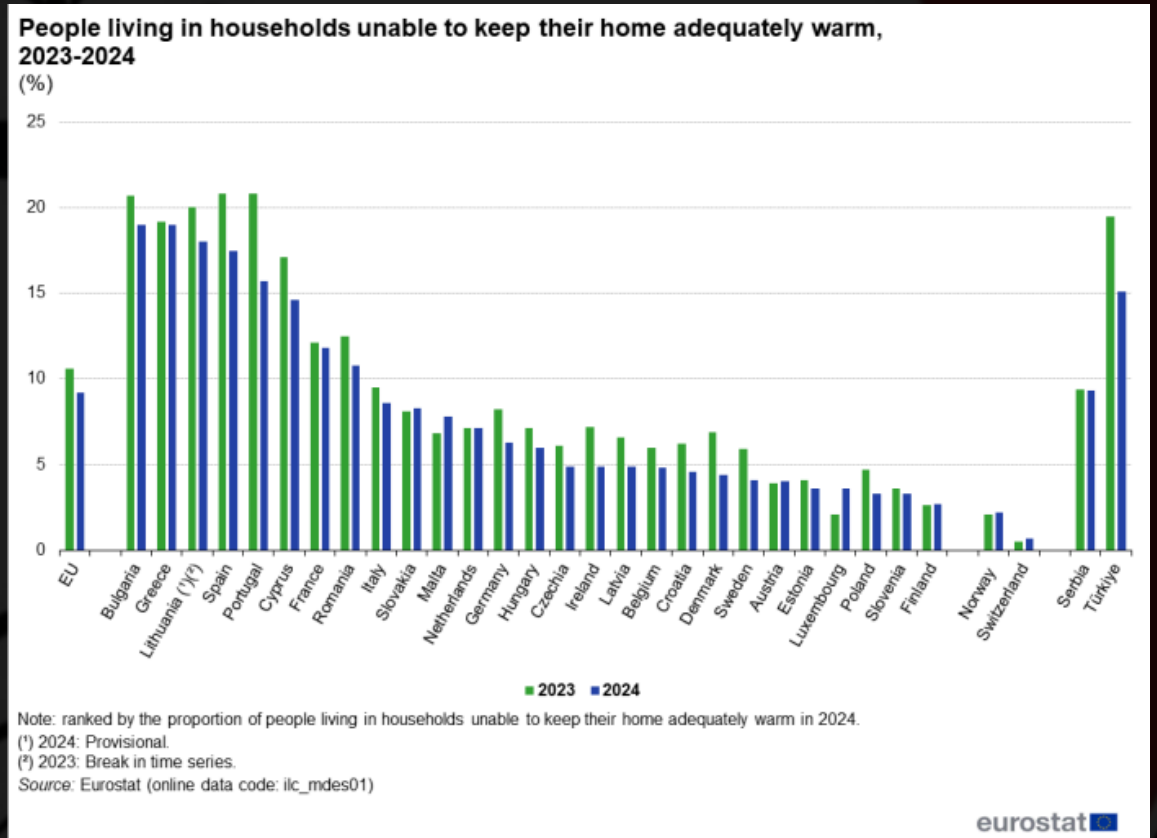
While imprisoned in Türkiye, Ekrem İmamoğlu was awarded the 2026 Paweł Adamowicz Award by European institutions for defending democracy and local self-government, exposing the stark contrast between international recognition of democratic values and their repression by the current government at home.



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HOMES WITHOUT OWNERS

Homeownership in Türkiye has dropped to 55.8 percent as housing prices outpace incomes and access to mortgages continues to shrink according to Eurostat.



Yet construction is accelerating at a record pace, consuming land and degrading soil without improving housing security.



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REGULATING MORALITY?

Turkey's media watchdog, RTÜK,
fined three national TV stations for
allegedly undermining "family
values" and normalizing "distorted
relationships," reinforcing long-
standing concerns that morality-
based regulations are being used
to censor content and restrict
LGBTQ+ visibility in Türkiye.



BIANET.ORG



While imposing these sanctions, the
state broadcaster TRT announced the
release of an openly anti-LGBTQ+
documentary portraying LGBTQ+
existence as a threat to children and
society, drawing criticism for using
public funds to legitimize
stigmatization and hate.



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WORK KILLS

*RECORD WORKPLACE DEATHS REVEAL THE COST OF
LAX SAFETY IN TÜRKİYE*



TURKISHMINUTE.COM

At least 2,105 workers were killed in workplace “accidents” in Türkiye in 2025—an 11 percent increase and the highest toll in a decade—according to Health and Safety Labor Watch, underscoring chronic failures in enforcement that continue to claim workers’ lives, including children and migrants.



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THE ARCHITECTURE OF SILENCE

FROM NEWSROOMS TO COURTROOMS TO PLATFORMS, HOW EXPRESSION IS CONTAINED IN TÜRKİYE



In 2025, journalism in Türkiye faced mass detentions, arrests, and sentencing, with legal pressure, police obstruction, and economic sanctions accelerating the collapse of press freedom. This repression intensified in late 2025 through prolonged detentions, heavy prison sentences, RTÜK fines, access bans, and trustee appointments targeting critical media

Türkiye ranked near the bottom of the World Happiness Report 2025, reflecting deep limits on freedom and trust.



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CELLS BEYOND CAPACITY

PRISON OVERCROWDING PERSISTS DESPITE FALLING INMATE NUMBERS IN TÜRKİYE



Turkey's prisons are operating at about 131.7% capacity, holding nearly 100,000 more inmates than they were built for, even though the total prison population recently fell slightly, in part due to judicial reform measures aimed at reducing overcrowding. The overcrowding still affects all types of facilities and includes children and pre-trial detainees, highlighting the ongoing strain in the penal system.



OUR NEXT PANEL WITH CAN DÜNDAR

*LIVESTREAMED ON OUR YOUTUBE CHANNEL
AT 12:00 PM EST. ON JANUARY 25, 2026*



March 19 Platform
CAN DÜNDAR'IN KATILIMIYLA

Calendar icon **25** Ocak 2026 Pazar

09.00-10.00 PST
Clock icon 12.00-13.00 EST
20.00-21.00 TSİ

YouTube icon **Youtube Canlı Yayını**

www.youtube.com/@March19Platform

CAN DÜNDAR
Gazeteci

Can Dündar is an investigative journalist, writer, and documentary filmmaker known for his work on Türkiye's recent history, politics, and popular culture, including the acclaimed 1993 documentary *Sarı Zeybek*.

After serving as editor-in-chief of *Cumhuriyet* in 2015 and facing judicial pressure, he went into exile in Germany. Despite an arrest warrant in Türkiye, he continues his journalism and advocacy for press freedom, democracy, and human rights through the independent platform #ÖZGÜRÜZ.